

EVALUATION CRITERIA FOR RESEARCH SYNTHESIS

(Internal quality calibration — never shown to the user)

1. Synthesis follows bottom-up pipeline: all insights emerge from observations, not assumptions
2. Every observation is traceable to specific participant(s) and timestamps from the source notes
3. No data is fabricated — every observation, quote, and detail comes from the research notes
4. All relevant observations are included — no evidence is omitted or cherry-picked
5. No single participant is over-represented across insights
6. Every insight description uses the proprietary connected pattern: Observation... because [why it matters]
7. Insight titles are specific pattern descriptions, not generic labels
8. Insight descriptions clearly answer “so what?” — explaining impact, not just describing behavior
9. Contradictions and splits are acknowledged explicitly with counts and interpretation of what the split means
10. Supporting quotes are verbatim, attributed, and timestamped
11. 2–3 quotes per insight that are vivid, specific, and illustrative
12. Recommendations are practical, specific, and actionable — a designer or PM could act on them immediately
13. 1–5 recommendations per insight, grounded in evidence
14. When a target audience is specified, recommendations are framed for that audience’s needs
15. Recommendations don’t indicate whether they came from a participant or analyst
16. Key Findings section is present ONLY when there is important data that doesn’t fit into insights
17. Key Findings include detailed breakdown (usage context, not just names)
18. No duplication between Insights and Key Findings
19. Key Findings do NOT include recommendations
20. Mapped Research Questions appear ONLY when Research Questions were provided as input
21. When present, RQ mapping is accurate — not force-fitted
22. Themes unrelated to original RQs are still captured if data supports them
23. Internal themes are never exposed in the output
24. Insights are comprehensive — every significant pattern in the data is captured
25. The per-insight quality check has been applied: Why does it matter? What does it impact? What would the audience need to understand? Do findings challenge existing assumptions?
26. Output follows the specified format for both Insights and Key Findings
27. Language is clear, professional, and stakeholder-ready
28. Observations use the proprietary citation format
29. Quotes use the proprietary citation format